

ACROSS TEAMS

Each team runs well inside its own leg.

How to align teams that keep tripping over each other.

AND THE CONSEQUENCE

The work gets lost in the interval between one and the next.

THE CASCADE

Why the tripping repeats.



WHAT YOU SEE

Each team is measured on its own leg...



THE MECHANISM

...nobody is measured on the exchange zone...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and the delay lives there, invisible to everyone.

Everyone hits their own goal and the client still gets it late.

THE FORK

Where the problem really sits.

WHERE IT REALLY IS

01

— ☐ Did the work stall inside one team? That is capacity.

02

— ☐ Did it stall at the handoff? That is a missing agreement.

03

— ☒ Does it come back for redoing? Format or criteria never agreed.

In most operations, the second and third add up to more than the first.

THE METHOD

The baton pass, four agreements.



01 WHAT GETS PASSED

the exact deliverable, with the minimum that has to be ready

02 IN WHAT FORMAT

the way the next team uses it, not the way that is easy for you

03 WITH HOW MUCH NOTICE

when the next one hears it is coming, and that it slipped

04 WHO CHECKS IT

who says received and usable, closing the handoff

Four lines per handoff. One hour long meeting settles the main ones.

WHAT TO ASK, IN ORDER

Four questions to ask the other team.

01 • WHAT GETS
PASSED

What do you receive from me today?

almost always the two descriptions do not match

02 • IN WHAT
FORMAT

What bothers you most about it?

this is where the rework you did not know you caused shows up

03 • WITH HOW
MUCH NOTICE

What would the ideal format be?

it usually costs little and saves hours on the other side

04 • WHO CHECKS
IT

When do you need to be told?

an agreed heads up is worth more than an apology afterward

TWO MODELS

Defending the fiefdom or agreeing the pass.

THE COMMON MODEL

Defending the fiefdom

Everyone tends their own number

Blames the neighboring team for delays

Sends the work in its own format

Finds the problem at the monthly meeting

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Agreeing the pass

Looks at the result of the whole flow

Investigates the handoff, not the person

Delivers in the format the other one uses

Warns before the problem lands

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three causes nobody treats.

01 Goals that compete between teams.

- when hitting your goal hurts theirs, the conflict is by design.

02 Nobody ever designed the whole flow.

- each team knows its own piece and nobody sees the whole line.

03 The handoff has no owner.

- inside the teams everything has an owner, in the gap nobody does.

Recurring conflict between teams is almost never about people, it is about design.

THE CHAIN

The dropped baton test.

01

Take the last significant delay in your area.



02

Ask, at what exact point did it stop?



03

Almost always it was at the handoff, not inside one team.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Do this with the last three delays and the pattern appears at once.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

One hour with the neighboring team.



STEP 01

Draw together the flow from request to delivery.

on one board, with the handoffs marked out clearly



STEP 02

Write the four agreements for the most critical handoff.

what gets passed, format, notice and who confirms



STEP 03

Book a review in thirty days.

with one simple number, how many times the baton dropped

Alignment is not born of joint meetings, it is born of border agreements.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Baton Pass, in the order that matters.



Work does not get lost inside teams. It gets lost in the space between them.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER

in the next meeting with the team that trips you most.

FABIO GARCIA

MANAGEMENT AS ENGINEERING
/IN/FALERCIA